

but when combined with flash sales and exclusives, it creates a real conundrum for a buyer.

There's not much that we can say about this aspect either, since it's a straightforward choice. If you can't get a phone on a flash sale or invite, or dislike them, you'll not buy it, and the company loses one prospective buyer. There's a reason big companies such as Samsung, Apple and Sony have spent crores of rupees to build brick and mortar stores, and booming as the online business may be, it's nowhere close to pushing these retailers out of the market, especially in a country like India.

SCREEN REPAIR COST

Perhaps the one aspect of a smartphone that uniformly affects all buyers, is the screen repair cost. We see people talking on smartphones with broken and battered displays regularly. While keywords such as Gorilla Glass and Dragontrail Glass are often thrown about, it's still glass, and glass breaks. Period.

So, what happens when the glass on your smartphone breaks? Think back. How many times has a friend of yours bought a new phone because it was going to cost too much to repair the display on his device? It's one of the areas where Samsung seems to excel. As expensive as AMOLED displays are, the company seems to be subsidising the cost, charging around ₹12,000 to fix a Galaxy S6 display, while Apple's Retina displays will cost you nearly ₹23,700. Remember

SCREEN REPAIR COST

	Screen Repair Cost	Original Launch Price	Percentage of Cost spent on Screen Repair
Flagships			
Samsung Galaxy S6	12000	49900	24.0480961924
LG G4	12942	51000	25.3764705882
iPhone 6	23700	52500	45.1428571429
20k-30k			
OnePlus One	7000	22999	30.4361059176
Honor 6 Plus	7000	22999	30.4361059176
Moto X (2nd Gen)	7350	31999	22.9694677959
Asus Zenfone 2	5700	19999	28.5014250713
15k-20k			
Honor 6	8000	17999	44.4469137174
Asus Zenfone 2	5700	19999	28.5014250713
Xiaomi Mi 4	9040	19999	45.202260113
10k-15k			
Xiaomi Mi 4i	4082	12999	31.4024155704
Asus Zenfone 2	5700	14999	38.0025335022
Moto G (3rd Gen)	5000	12999	38.464497269
7k-10k			
Yu Yureka Plus	1800	9999	18.00180018
5k-7k			
Xiaomi Redmi 2	2700	6999	38.5769395628
Yu Yuphoria	2500	6999	35.7193884841
Moto E (2nd Gen)	3400	7999	42.5053131641

the story of the guy who broke his iPhone 6 screen the minute he walked out of the store with it? Yeah, he probably cursed hard. In addition, companies such as LG and Samsung are providing a one-time free screen replacement offers on some of their flagship devices, which is good for a buyer.

Repairing a broken screen can cost you as much as 50% of a smartphone's original price, and that's a big deal. So, researching on this before you buy a phone is a good idea. The information is readily available too. Take the direction we took for example. We have access to all the companies, but we simply called each company's service centre and asked how much a broken screen would cost to fix. The calls lasted about a minute each and we had our answers. Easy peasy.

Xiaomi VP, Hugo Barra, once said on stage, that the cost of a smartphone can be doubled by simply going from a HD to Full HD display. And that's perhaps the best way to explain why the cost of screen repair is an important part of your buying decision. The top end phones will have expensive displays, while lower end phones should have comparatively cheaper displays, when compared to the original price. The idea is to figure out what percentage of the phone's original cost is accounted by the screen, and whether a broken screen would force you to buy a new phone.

From our research, we find that both Samsung and LG score big in this depart-



Xiaomi Mi 4i